Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

This project was part of the Digital Literacy course. Before starting, I honestly thought digital literacy just meant knowing how to use apps and browse the internet. I didn't realise it also included things like how you communicate online, how you present yourself professionally, and how to stay safe from scams and fraud.

There were five tasks in total, each covering something different. Looking back, each one taught me something I didn't know I was missing.

Task 1: Infographic Write-up

For this task I made a digital literacy infographic on Canva. I picked a template and changed it according to what I wanted to show — things like what digital literacy means, basic internet safety, and email etiquette.

Honestly the hardest part was deciding what to put in and what to leave out. An infographic can't have too much text or it stops making sense visually. I had to keep simplifying until it felt clean. It was the first time I tried presenting information this way instead of just writing it out, and it was actually more challenging than I expected.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio Write-up

This task was about setting up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle. I had heard of all three but never actually made proper accounts. GitHub is where you put your projects and code, LinkedIn is more for professional connections and finding internships, and Kaggle is good for practising data and coding problems.

Setting them up made me realise how empty my online presence was. Right now the profiles don't have much, but at least they exist and I know what they're for. I plan to add projects and skills as I keep learning.

Task 3: Platforms Write-up

For this task I used HackerRank and Google Forms. On HackerRank I tried a beginner level problem. It wasn't too difficult but it showed me how these platforms track your progress and rank you, which is actually a good motivator.

For Google Forms I made a five question quiz on digital literacy, submitted a response myself and then checked how it showed up in Google Sheets. I didn't know Forms and Sheets were connected like that — it actually seems really useful for collecting data quickly without any extra work.

Task 4: Email Etiquette Write-up

This task had two parts. First I wrote two emails — one to a professor asking for an assignment extension and one to a company asking about internship opportunities. Second I made a Do's and Don'ts list for social media.

Writing the emails was more thought-provoking than I expected. I kept second guessing my tone — too formal sounds stiff, too casual sounds unprofessional. The email to the company was harder because I had to sound confident without overselling myself, which is difficult when you're a first year with almost no experience.

The checklist part made me think about how casually most of us use social media without really thinking about what we're putting out there.

Task 5: Cybercrime Write-up

I picked UPI fraud for this task. While going through how it works I was genuinely surprised at how convincing these scams can look. The scammer creates urgency, sends a collect request, and asks for your PIN to "receive" money. Most people don't know that entering your PIN means you're sending money, not getting it. That one detail is what makes the whole scam work.

It made me more careful about how quickly I react to messages or calls that feel urgent. My first instinct now would be to pause and verify rather than act immediately.

Conclusion

This project covered a lot more than I expected. Each task was different and each one left me with something practical — whether it was learning how to design an infographic, setting up profiles I should have had already, or understanding how UPI fraud actually works. I feel more aware now, both about opportunities online and about risks. That's probably the most useful thing I got out of this.

References

- Canva (infographic design)
- GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle (profile setup)
- HackerRank (coding practice)
- Google Forms and Google Sheets (quiz and data collection)
- cybercrime.gov.in (cyber safety reference)